possibly we had a chance of getting somewhere with the new man in the Kremlin.

As Gorbachev and I talked beside the fire, it was clear he believed completely in the Soviet way of life and accepted a lot of the propaganda he'd heard about America: that munitions makers ruled our country, black people were treated like slaves, half our population slept in the streets.

Yet I also sensed he was willing to listen and that possibly he sensed, as I did, that on both sides of the Iron Curtain there were myths and misconceptions that had contributed to misunderstandings and our potentially fatal mistrust of each other.

I knew that he also had strong motives for wanting to end the arms race. The Soviet economy was a basket case, in part because of enormous expenditures on arms. He had to know that the quality of American military technology, after reasserting itself beginning in 1981, was now overwhelmingly superior to his. He had to know we could outspend the Soviets on weapons as long as we wanted to.

"We have a choice," I told him. "We can agree to reduce arms—or we can continue the arms race, *which I think you know you can't win*. We won't stand by and let you maintain weapon superiority over us. But together we can try to do something about ending the arms race."

Our meeting beside the glowing hearth went on for an hour and a half, and when it was over, I couldn't help but think something fundamental had changed in the relationship between our countries. Now I knew we had to keep it going. To paraphrase Robert Frost, there would be many miles to go before we sleep.

As we walked up the hill toward the house where our advisors were still meeting, I told Gorbachev: "You know, you've never seen the United States before, never been there. I think you'd enjoy a visit to our country. Why don't